

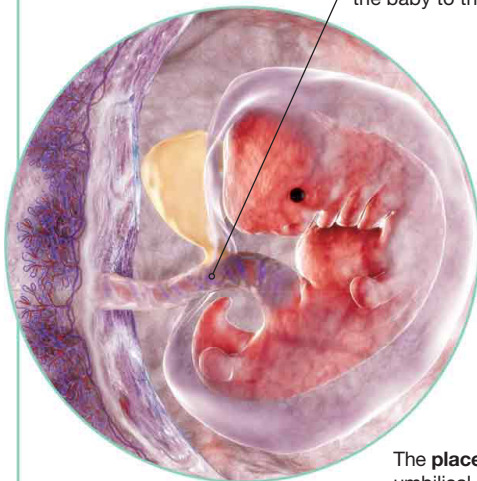
In the womb

A baby grows, protected and cared for, within its mother's uterus, or womb. Over a period of nine months, known as pregnancy, a tiny ball of cells develops into a human being ready to be born.

From embryo to fetus

For the first eight weeks, the developing baby is called an embryo, and after that it is a fetus. It is protected in a bag of fluid and receives food and oxygen through the umbilical cord and placenta.

The **umbilical cord** links the baby to the placenta



At **5 weeks**, the bean-sized embryo's heart is beating and other organs are developing. Budlike limbs are starting to grow.

The **placenta** links the umbilical cord to the mother's blood supply



At **8 weeks**, the strawberry-sized fetus has a recognizable face. Its head and brain grow rapidly, and bones start to form.